

SIMPLE SPEAKER GUIDE

Nature Based Solutions for Efficient Use of Water Resources

This guide uses easier words than the first version. Practice the idea of each slide, then speak naturally. Do not memorize every sentence.

Slide 1 Title**SAY THIS**

Today I will talk about Nature Based Solutions for using water better. The simple idea is to work with nature, not only with pipes and concrete.

Plants, soil, wetlands, and floodplains can slow water, store water, and clean water.

POINT TO

The three words: Slow, Store, Filter.

Slide 2 Why water use needs a new view**SAY THIS**

Water problems are not only about having too little water. The problem is also where the water is, when it arrives, and how clean it is.

Farming uses the most water, and many places will face water stress. So we need solutions that work across the whole land area.

REMEMBER

Say the numbers quickly. Do not stay too long on this slide.

Slide 3 What Nature Based Solutions mean

SAY THIS

Nature Based Solutions use healthy natural systems to solve human problems. In water management, nature becomes useful infrastructure.

For example, wetlands can clean water, plants can reduce erosion, and floodplains can hold extra water during storms.

POINT TO

The map. Show that hills, rivers, farms, wetlands, and cities are connected.

Slide 4 How it works

SAY THIS

Nature Based Solutions change what happens to rain. Instead of rushing away fast and dirty, water can be caught, slowed, cleaned, stored, and sent back into the ground.

This makes more water useful later, especially during dry times.

POINT TO

- Catch
- Slow
- Clean
- Store
- Refill

Slide 5 The river area is connected

SAY THIS

A river area works like one connected system. What happens upstream affects farms, cities, wetlands, and rivers downstream.

The same storm can become a flood, stored water, or clean river flow depending on the land it passes through.

POINT TO

Move your hand from hills to rivers, farms, and cities.

Slide 6 River restoration example

SAY THIS

This example shows a straight damaged channel changed back into a bending stream.

River bends make the water path longer. That slows water, helps water enter the ground, improves habitat, and can reduce flooding.

POINT TO

Before, during, and after photos. Tell it like a short story.

Slide 7 Future water risks

SAY THIS

Climate change makes water problems bigger. Droughts can become more common, river water can become less available, groundwater can be under more pressure, and pollution can increase.

This is why we need solutions that give several benefits at once.

TIP

Do not explain every number in detail. Use them to show urgency.

Slide 8 Farming and water

SAY THIS

Water security and food security are connected. Farming needs a lot of water, especially irrigation.

Better farming means smarter watering, healthier soil, and landscapes that keep rivers and groundwater working.

POINT TO

The bars comparing rain based farms and irrigated farms.

Slide 9 Choose the right solution

SAY THIS

Not every place needs the same solution. A dry farming area, a polluted farming area, and a flood prone farming area need different choices.

The main message is simple: first understand the local problem, then choose the Nature Based Solution that fits.

TIP

Mention one example from each card, not every bullet.

Slide 10 Water quantity

SAY THIS

For water quantity, we want to use less water and store more water naturally.

On farms, this can mean low water crops, mulch, cover crops, and careful irrigation. Across the landscape, it means wetlands, river side plants, floodplains, and groundwater refill areas.

POINT TO

The two groups: On farms and Across the landscape.

Slide 11 Water quality

SAY THIS

It is easier to stop pollution before it reaches the river. Fast runoff can carry soil, fertilizer, and chemicals into water.

Plants, wetlands, soil, and river side buffers slow the water and help clean it before it reaches rivers and lakes.

POINT TO

The Chesapeake Bay example. Say that pollution was reduced before entering the Bay.

Slide 12**Flood risk****SAY THIS**

Floodplains give water room to spread safely during storms. This lowers pressure downstream.

They can also help farms, refill groundwater, reduce erosion, and create habitat for wildlife.

TIP

Use the 24% number to show that many croplands face flood risk.

Slide 13**Cities as sponges****SAY THIS**

Cities usually send rain away quickly. A sponge city holds rain, lets it soak into the ground, cleans it, and sometimes reuses it.

Green swales, rain gardens, storage ponds, green roofs, and built wetlands all help with this.

POINT TO

The five urban examples.

Slide 14**Management****SAY THIS**

Nature Based Solutions are living systems, so they need care over time.

Good management means planning before the project, checking results after the project, and listening to local people throughout the process.

POINT TO

Planning, Monitoring, Consultation.

Slide 15

How to start a project

SAY THIS

A good project starts by understanding the area and the main water problem. Then we choose the right solution, design it with local people, find funding, and keep checking and improving it.

This is how small projects can become part of a stronger whole landscape.

TIP

Say each step in one sentence.

Slide 16

Limits

SAY THIS

Nature Based Solutions help a lot, but they cannot do everything. They must match the local place and the local problem.

Sometimes we still need pipes, dams, rules, and maintenance. The best design often combines natural and built solutions.

SOUND BALANCED

This slide shows that you understand both strengths and limits.

Slide 17

Final message

SAY THIS

The final message is: work with the water cycle, not against it.

Efficient water use means using less water, slowing runoff, storing water, cleaning pollution, refilling groundwater, and managing fairly. The best projects give more than one benefit at the same time.

POINT TO

The formula column. Read it slowly.

Slide 18**Sources****SAY THIS**

These are the main sources used for the presentation. They provide the definition, the landscape types, global water data, and the figures and videos.

I will not read all of them, but they show where the information came from.

KEEP SHORT

This slide should take about 15 seconds.

Slide 19**Thank you****SAY THIS**

Thank you for your attention. I will be happy to answer your questions.

If you want to add one final sentence, say: the main point is that water efficiency should be designed through the whole landscape, not only through machines and pipes.

DELIVERY

Pause, smile, and look at the audience.

Suggested timing: about 35 to 45 seconds for each main slide. Spend less time on the Sources and Thank you slides.